SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #2 · SCARCITY AND SECURITY

“Anything I have could vanish tomorrow.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

A sudden loss of a job, a home, a loved one, or savings can teach us that nothing is safe. A parent who lost everything, or who lived in constant fear of loss, may have passed that fear along without a word. After a hard blow, the mind tries to protect us by expecting the next one.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is honest that earthly things can be lost. Jesus said moth, rust, and thieves can destroy what we store up on earth, and He pointed us to treasure that cannot be taken. God also gives a promise that does not depend on what we own: He will never leave us or forsake us. These verses do not say we will never lose anything. They say that what matters most is held securely, and that God is with us through every loss.

> *“Keep your lives free from the love of money and be content with what you have, for God has said: ‘Never will I leave you, never will I forsake you.’”* (Hebrews 13:5).

Also see

> “Do not store up for yourselves treasures on earth, where moth and rust destroy, and where thieves break in and steal. But store up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where moth and rust do not destroy, and where thieves do not break in and steal. For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also” (Matthew 6:19–21).

> “God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble. Therefore we will not fear, though the earth is transformed and the mountains are toppled into the depths of the seas” (Psalm 46:1–2).

> “The LORD is my chosen portion and my cup; You have made my lot secure” (Psalm 16:5).

> “When you pass through the waters, I will be with you; and when you go through the rivers, they will not overwhelm you. When you walk through the fire, you will not be scorched; the flames will not set you ablaze” (Isaiah 43:2).

Common self-statements

- Whatever I build can be taken away.
- I cannot let myself get comfortable.
- Just when things are good, something will happen.
- I should not get attached to anything.
- Having less means losing less.
- Safety is an illusion.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting loss before anything has happened.
- Overgeneralizing: Turning one painful loss into “everything is at risk.”
- Catastrophizing: Treating a possible loss as certain and unbearable.
- Discounting the positive: Dismissing what is stable and secure right now.

Challenging questions

- What loss did I live through, and am I treating today as if it were that day?
- What, right now, is secure and likely to stay?
- If I did lose something, what has God given me to get through it?
- What is the difference between being careful and living in dread?
- What can I not lose, according to Scripture?
- Who could stand with me in a hard time?

Truth summary

> Possessions and circumstances can change, and some losses are real. But I am not alone, and what matters most is held by God. I can be careful without living in dread, and enjoy what I have today without fearing every tomorrow.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Refuge/Safety
- Protection
- Riches, Beware of
- Trust
- Fear

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Trouble/Hardship
- Anxiety/Worry/Fear

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Whom Shall I Fear — Chris Tomlin
God's presence provides courage without requiring a life free of difficulty.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Turn Your Eyes Upon Jesus — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn directs attention to Christ when fear or earthly concerns dominate.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Anything I have could vanish tomorrow"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Anything I have could vanish tomorrow." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What loss am I still reacting to?
- ☐ What is secure today?
- ☐ What has God given me to cope with loss?
- ☐ How can I be careful without dread?
- ☐ What treasure cannot be taken?
- ☐ Who can stand with me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God is with me, whatever happens to my things.
- ☐ I can enjoy what I have today.
- ☐ Being careful is wise; dread is not.
- ☐ My most important treasure cannot be taken.
- ☐ I have survived hard things before.
- ☐ I do not face loss alone.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Hebrews 13:5**
  "Keep your lives free from the love of money and be content with what you have, for God has said: 'Never will I leave you, never will I forsake you.'"
- ☐ **Matthew 6:19–21**
  "Do not store up for yourselves treasures on earth, where moth and rust destroy, and where thieves break in and steal. But store up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where moth and rust do not destroy, and where thieves do not break in and steal. For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also."
- ☐ **Psalm 46:1–2**
  "God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble. Therefore we will not fear, though the earth is transformed and the mountains are toppled into the depths of the seas."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What is secure today: Each day, write down one thing that is secure and one fear about loss. Rate your fear from 0 to 10 and note any change.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Hebrews 13:5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God will never leave me, so I can enjoy today without dread.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Refuge/Safety" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Make a short "what is secure" list. Include people, faith, health, skills, and savings. Read it when fear about loss rises.
- [ ] Take one practical protective step. Update a document, review insurance, or back up important files. Then stop and rest.
- [ ] Enjoy one thing without fear. Spend ten minutes enjoying something you have, such as a meal or a walk, and notice the fear without following it.
- [ ] Tell one trusted person about a fear of loss. Notice how it feels to share it.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Anything I have could vanish tomorrow": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Something secure
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Anything I have could vanish tomorrow.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You know the losses I have carried. Hold me when I fear more. Help me enjoy what You have given, and remind me that You will never leave me or forsake me. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.